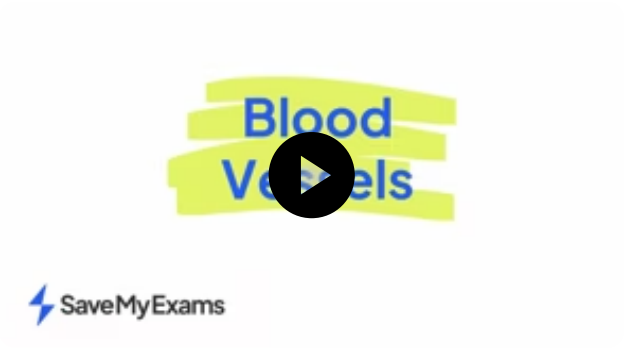
Blood Vessels

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

Download PDF

Written by: Lára Marie McIvor
Reviewed by: Lucy Kirkham
Updated on 24 December 2025



Did this video help you? Yes No

Help me understand

Arteries, veins & capillaries

- The blood vessels are a system of closed tubes within which blood flows
- Different types of blood vessels transport blood in different directions, and to different parts of the body

Arteries

- These blood vessels carry blood **away from the heart** at high pressure
- Arteries transport **oxygenated** blood
  - The single exception to this is the pulmonary artery
- The walls of arteries are **thick** and **muscular** and contain **elastic fibres**
- Arteries have a **narrow lumen**

Veins

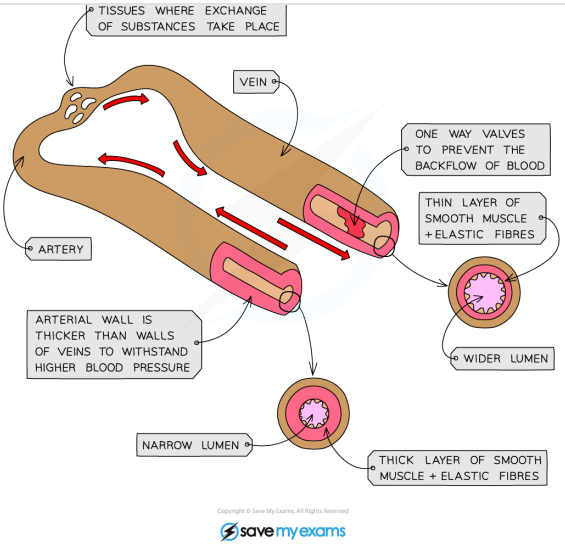
- These blood vessels carry blood **towards the heart** at low pressure
- Veins transport **deoxygenated** blood away from the body
  - The single exception to this is the pulmonary vein
- The walls of veins are **thin** in comparison to arteries
- Veins have a **wide lumen**
- **Valves** in veins prevent blood from flowing backwards

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

Arteries and veins diagram

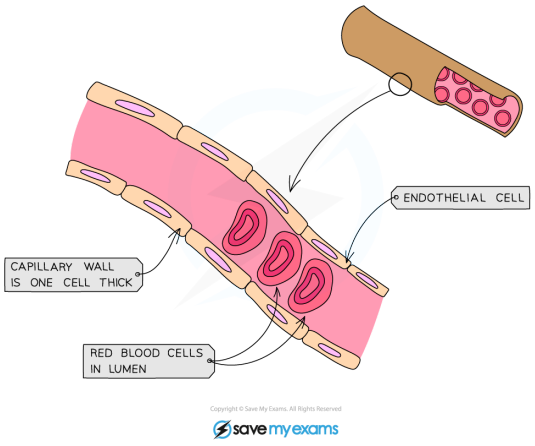


Arteries carry blood away from the heart at high pressure, while veins carry blood towards the heart at low pressure

Capillaries

- These blood vessels carry blood **to the cells** of the tissues
- Capillaries transport **oxygenated** blood from the arteries to the cells, and **deoxygenated** blood from the cells to the veins
- The walls of capillaries are **one cell thick** and contain gaps to allow fluid to leak out
- Capillaries have a very **narrow lumen**

Capillaries diagram



Capillaries are tiny blood vessels that carry blood to the cells of the body

Teacher only

Fresh, expert-written questions
Students can't access them
Fair accurate tests - built fast
Explore in Test Builder
Test yourself
Flashcards
Was this revision note helpful?
Yes
No

Previous
Next

© Copyright 2015–2026 Save My Exams Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Neither IBO nor College Board were involved in the production of, and do not endorse, the resources created by Save My Exams.